

12 Using discourse markers

Discourse markers can be used to show a relationship between two sentences, or parts of a sentence. This can be cause, effect, emphasis, contrast, or comparison.

⚙️ **New language** Linking information

Aa **Vocabulary** Family history

🧩 **New skill** Talking about relationships

12.1 KEY LANGUAGE INFORMAL LINKING DISCOURSE MARKERS

Some discourse markers are mostly used in informal writing and speech.



I like listening to music, **but though** my mother hates it.

Shows contrast.



He's a talented swimmer, **like just as** his great-grandfather was.

Shows comparison.



Staying in touch is easy, **because since as** we all have smartphones.

Shows cause.



We grew up together, **so** we tell each other everything. We are very close. **As a result**, we know everything about each other.

Shows effect.



All my siblings are tall, **especially particularly** my older sister.

Shows emphasis.

TIP

To emphasize the relationship between words when speaking, you can add stress to the discourse marker.

